

Paul Schöpfer

Amsterdam, Netherlands

paul.schoepfer@pm.me

Education

- 2024–ongoing **PhD in Development Economics**, Wageningen University & Research, Netherlands
Thesis: Enhancing Life Outcomes through Education: Skills, Access to Education, and Pedagogical Innovations in Low-Income Contexts
Supervisors: Dr.Joost de Laat, Dr.Esther Gehrke, Dr.Thomas van Huizen
- 2021–2022 **Master of Science in Economic Policy**, Utrecht University, Netherlands
- 2016–2021 **Bachelor of Science in Economics**, University of Vienna, Austria
- 2007–2015 **Secondary Education**, Graz International Bilingual School, Graz, Austria

Professional Experience

- 2022–Present **Junior Researcher**, Utrecht University School of Economics, Netherlands
- Designed and conducted randomized controlled trials (RCTs) and quasi-experimental evaluations, with a focus on education.
 - Led research projects on garden-based education and on students' foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN) skills in Sub-Saharan Africa.
 - Developed measurement instruments (surveys, indices, reliability checks) and carried out causal analyses (STATA, R).
 - Co-authored research proposals and contributed to successful external funding applications.
 - Lectured master's-level course "Economics of Global Challenges," incorporating community-engaged learning partnerships with organizations in rural Kenya.
 - Organized and facilitated international knowledge-exchange workshops with academics, policymakers, and practitioners.
 - Active member of the International Community Engaged Learning (ICEL) team: co-developed the UEngage platform and served as guest editor of a special issue on international community-engaged learning (*Journal of Higher Education Outreach and Engagement*).
- 2022 **Research Assistant**, Utrecht University School of Economics, Netherlands
- Supported data collection, cleaning, and analysis for education-focused RCTs.
 - Developed and defended a master's thesis on education and development economics.
- 2019–2021 **Intern**, Austrian Financial Market Supervision, Vienna, Austria

- Drafted press releases, briefing notes, and external communications for senior management.
- Assisted in planning and execution of national and international financial conferences.

2018 **Executive Secretary**, Federal Chancellery Republic of Austria, Vienna, Austria

- Coordinated and organized high-level meetings and events during Austria's EU Council presidency.

Teaching Experience

2025 **Lecturer, Economics of Global Challenges** — Academic Years 2025/2026-2024/2025, Utrecht University

- Led tutorials and provided academic support in a course addressing major global issues from an economic perspective.
- Coordinated the International Community Engaged Learning (ICEL) component, collaborating with a pastoral community in southern Kenya.

2025 **Co-coordinator, Tackling Real-World Problems through Interdisciplinary Collaboration (TIC)** — Academic Year 2024/2025, Utrecht University

- Designed and managed an interdisciplinary course focused on real-world problem-solving, in collaboration with societal organizations including Commonland, RIVM, Triodos Bank, and Stichting Vluchteling.

2024 **Course Instructor, Thematic Interdisciplinary Challenge (TIC)** — Academic Year 2023/2024, Utrecht University

- Taught and supervised student teams in a project-based course tackling societal challenges through interdisciplinary methods.

Publications

2024 Heller Crespo, R., van der Harst, M., Schöpfer, P., et al. (2024). Integrating Whole Child Development into Teacher Training. *NORRAG*. <https://resources.norrag.org/resource/view/832/461>

2024 Schöpfer, P., van der Harst, M., et al. (2024). Integrating Measurement into Education Systems. *NORRAG*. <https://resources.norrag.org/resource/view/832/461>

Editorial Roles

2025 Guest Editor, Special Issue “*International Community-Engaged Learning (ICEL)*”, *Journal of Higher Education Outreach and Engagement*, Vol. 29, Issue 2. <https://openjournals.libs.uga.edu/jheoe/article/view/4371/3541>

Volunteering and Civil Service

2020–2021 **Volunteer**, Austrian Red Cross, Vienna, Austria

- Co-developed Vienna’s COVID-19 testing strategy in coordination with public health authorities.
- Managed daily testing operations, coordinating logistics and staff for up to 1,200 tests per day.

2015–2016 **Civil Servant**, Austrian Red Cross, Graz, Austria

- Completed Austria’s mandatory civil service as a full-time member of the Red Cross emergency services team.
- Assisted in medical transports, first aid, and community health support.

Skills

Programming: STATA, R, LaTeX, NVivo

Languages: German (C2), English (C1), Spanish (B1), Dutch (A2), French (A1)